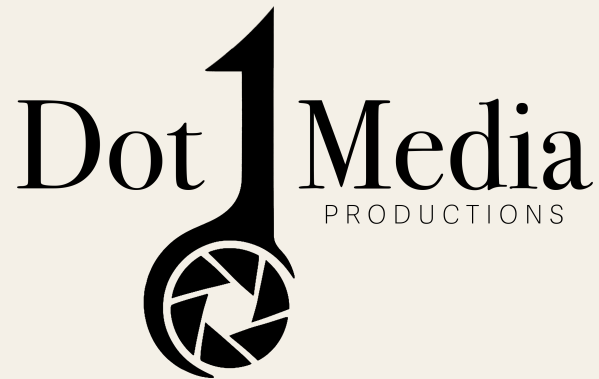




DOT ONE MEDIA • CLIENT PORTAL

Studio Admin Guide

Running the studio side of the portal, task by task.

Create with Purpose

`portal.dot1.media`

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1. Getting into the studio side

The portal has two front doors: one for clients and one for studio staff.

1. Go to **portal.dot1.media** and open the **studio login** (the staff sign in, kept separate from the client login; if you are not sure of the exact link, ask Dennis to save it for you or bookmark it).
2. Enter your studio email and password and choose **Sign in**.
3. You land on the **Studio Dashboard**.

A few notes:

- Only emails on the studio staff list can sign in here. If you ever add a new staff member, their email has to be added to that list first (this is a small change in the code; Dennis or whoever maintains the code can do it).

- Use **Sign out** (in the menu) when you are done on a shared computer.
- You can **Install the Dot One app** when the portal offers it, which puts an icon on your phone or desktop so you can open the studio portal like an app.

2. Your three daily views: Dashboard, Calendar, Sessions

Once you are in, most of your work happens across three areas.

- **Studio Dashboard (Home):** your at a glance view, including **Upcoming sessions**. Start here each day.
- **Calendar:** your bookings laid out by day, color coded by type of work (photography, video, music, government). Good for seeing your week and your open days at a glance.
- **Sessions:** the full list of every session (client bookings and ones you entered yourself). This is where you open a single session to work on it.

There is also a **Search** (a command palette). Start typing a client name or a section name to jump straight to it. If nothing matches you will see "No matches. Try a client name or a tab."

3. Managing a session from booking to delivery (the main workflow)

This is the heart of the studio side. Every project moves through a series of **stages**, and the client sees exactly where things stand on their own screen. Your job is to move each session forward as the work progresses.

The stages, in order:

1. **Session Scheduled:** the session is on the calendar; details still to be confirmed.
2. **Booked & Confirmed:** everything is locked in.
3. **Day of Session:** the day you capture the work.
4. **Post-Session:** the shoot is done; files are backed up while you select the best.
5. **Editing:** you are editing and crafting the final pieces.
6. **Pre-Delivery Review:** the client's preview is ready for them to look at.
7. **Final Delivery:** the finished work is delivered; the project is complete.

To move a session forward:

1. Open **Sessions** and click the session you want to work on.
2. You will see the stage steps. Advance the session to the next stage as the work reaches that point (for example, move it to **Editing** once you start editing).
3. The client's view updates to match, and the portal sends them a notification that their project moved forward. So only advance a stage when it is genuinely true, because the client is told each time.

To move a session backward (if you advanced it by mistake, or need to revisit a step), use **Reopen** to step it back.

When a session reaches **Final Delivery**, you will see a note that the session is complete. From here the client can also be prompted to leave a review (see Section 7).

4. Booking a client yourself (internal booking)

Use this when you are taking a booking on the client's behalf, for example a mini session, a walk up, or a client who booked over the phone. An internal booking does not create a client account and does not send the client through the online sign and pay flow.

1. Open the **internal booking** option (labeled **Book a session for a client / Internal booking**).
2. Choose the **Service group** (photography, video, music, or government).
3. Choose the **Service** within that group. The **Total price** fills in from the service.
4. Enter the **Client name** and **Client email**.
5. Pick a **date and time**.
6. Save the booking.

The portal will stop you and tell you what is missing if you skip a step, with prompts like "Choose a service.", "Enter a valid client email.", or "Pick a date and time."

Internal bookings show up in your Sessions list and Calendar alongside everything else, and you manage them through the same stages.

5. Creating a direct booking link for one client

Use this when you want to hold a specific slot for a specific client and send them a personal link to complete their own booking (create their account, sign, and pay). This is the best of both worlds: the slot is reserved so no

one else can take it, but the client still signs and pays through the normal flow.

1. Open **Direct links** (**Create a link / Reserve a slot for one specific client**).
2. Choose the **Service group**, then the **Service / project type**.
3. Pick a **date and time** for the reserved slot.
4. Create the link. You will see "Direct booking link created and slot reserved."
5. **Copy the link** ("Link copied to clipboard.") and send it to your client however you like (text, email, message).

You can see everything you have sent under **Sent & reserved links**. If the portal ever asks you to select the link text to copy it, just highlight the link and copy it manually.

6. Requesting a payment

Use this to ask a client to pay for something after booking, such as a balance, an add-on you agreed on later, or any extra item. The client sees it on their project screen with a **Pay now** button.

1. Open the **session** for that client in **Sessions**.
2. Find **Payment requests**.
3. Add a **description** (what the payment is for) and an **amount** (the field shows \$0.00 until you enter one).
4. Save it.

If you leave either part blank, the portal will remind you: "Add a description and an amount."

The client will see the request on their screen under the extra items your studio has added, and can pay it securely through Square. Music and government work is handled as a quote rather than online payment, by design.

7. Delivering the finished work

Photo galleries are delivered through **CloudSpot** (the studio's gallery tool), and the portal links the client to their gallery. Video and other files can be delivered by link as well.

Important safety feature: pasting a delivery link into a session does **not** email the client automatically. Nothing is sent until you explicitly confirm it. This is on purpose, so a client is never emailed a wrong or half ready link.

1. In **CloudSpot**, get the client's gallery share link (or the link to wherever the finished files live).

2. Open the client's **session** in the portal.
3. Paste the link into the delivery field (it accepts a gallery or file link, for example a CloudSpot gallery URL or a video link).
4. Save the link. At this point the client is **not** notified yet.
5. When you are ready, **confirm** the delivery. That is what actually notifies the client and marks the work as delivered.
6. Move the session to **Final Delivery** if you have not already.

Once delivered, the client sees that their finished work is ready, along with a link to view it. After a project wraps, the client can also be prompted to leave a review ("Loved working with us?").

8. Messaging a client

Each session has its own message thread with the client, so all conversation about a project stays in one place.

1. Open the **session**.
2. Find **Messages with the studio**.
3. Type your note (the box says "Send a note to the client...") and send it.

When a client sends you a message, it shows as new. On the client's side, they see your replies and can mark them as read.

9. Rescheduling a session

1. Open the **session**.
2. Choose **Move to a new date & time**.
3. Pick the new date and time and confirm.

The session updates on your Calendar and Sessions list, and the client's view reflects the new date. Clients can also request a new date themselves from their screen ("Request a new date"), which comes to you to confirm.

10. Managing services and add-ons

Your list of services (and their prices and add-ons) is managed inside the portal, so you can change what you offer without anyone touching code.

To add or edit a service:

1. Go to the service management area in the studio settings.
2. Add a new service or open an existing one to edit.
3. Set the **Service name**, a **Description**, the group it belongs to, and its price.
4. Set **Pad before** and **Pad after** if you want buffer time blocked off around the session (for setup and travel).
5. Set **Add-on availability** to control which add-ons can be chosen with this service.
6. Save. You can also hide a service (mark it **Hidden**) so it stays in the system but is not bookable.

Add-ons (extra options like an extra hour) are managed the same way, with a name, a price, and any extra time they add to the session.

11. Setting your availability

The portal only offers clients the days and times you are open.

1. Go to the availability area in the studio settings (you will see **Upcoming open days**, with **Open from** and **From / Until** times).
2. Set the days and hours you are available.
3. Save. Clients booking online will only be shown open slots that fit.

If a client ever says there are no times available, this is the first place to check (see Troubleshooting).

12. Importing past sessions from Acuity

If you have history in Acuity Scheduling you want reflected in the portal, you can import it from a CSV file. Imported appointments come in as completed sessions in your history, and **no emails are sent to anyone** during an import.

1. In Acuity, export your appointments to a CSV file.

2. In the portal, go to **Business** and find **Import past sessions** ("Upload your Acuity CSV export").
3. Upload the CSV file.
4. The portal reads it and adds the sessions.

Messages you might see and what they mean:

- **"Nothing new to import."**: everything in that file is already in the portal.
- **"No importable rows found in that file."** or **"That file has no rows."**: the file did not contain sessions the portal could read; double check you exported the right thing.
- **"Could not read that CSV file."**: the file was not a readable CSV; try exporting again, and use **Choose another file**.

A word of caution: importing the same file more than once can create duplicates. Import each export once.

13. Payments and receipts

Payments run through **Square**, and the portal keeps its own record of them plus emails receipts through the studio's email service.

- **Viewing receipts**: the **Business** area has a **Receipts** section.
- **Syncing from Square**: use **Sync from Square** to pull in any recent payments Square has that the portal has not recorded yet. If everything is already current you will see "Receipts are already up to date."
- **Resending a receipt**: you can re email a receipt to a client; you will see "Receipt emailed to ..." when it sends.

If a client says they paid but you do not see it, syncing from Square is usually the fix (see Troubleshooting).

14. Business insights and exports

The **Business** area also gives you a read on how things are going.

- **Insights** shows **Revenue by service line**, **Bookings by session type**, and **Revenue by month**. You can filter by a date range, or view **All time**.
- **Export** lets you download your records as spreadsheets: sessions, clients, and analytics. Handy for bookkeeping and taxes. You will see a confirmation like "Analytics exported." when a download is ready.

If there is no data for what you asked, you will see a gentle note such as "No sessions in that date range." or "No booking data to export yet."

15. Appearance and settings

- **Appearance:** under the theme settings you can change the **Portal color theme**, set a **Custom accent** color, or **Reset to default**.
 - **Notifications:** manage the studio notification settings.
 - **Calendar sync:** you can connect **Google Calendar** or **Apple Calendar** so bookings flow onto your own calendar.
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16. Troubleshooting

Work calmly through these. Most issues have a simple cause.

A client says they cannot log in. - Confirm they are using the **client login**, not the studio login. - Have them try **Forgot password?** to reset it (they get a reset link by email). - Confirm the email they are using is the same one their booking was made under. - If they never created a password (for example, you made an internal booking for them), they will not have a client account to log into; that is expected for internal bookings.

A client says they did not get a confirmation, receipt, or reset email. - Ask them to check spam and promotions folders. - Confirm the email address on their session is spelled correctly. - For a receipt, you can resend it from the **Receipts** section. - Occasional email delays happen; if it is truly missing, resending is the quickest fix.

A client says they paid, but the session still shows a balance. - Check **Square** first to confirm the payment actually went through. - If Square shows the money but the portal does not, use **Sync from Square** in the Receipts section, or the check/verify option on the session, to pull it in. - The money is not lost; this is almost always a confirmation catching up.

A payment failed or a card was declined. - This is between the client's bank and Square. Have the client try again or use a different card. - Music and government services do not take online payment on purpose; those are quoted.

A booking looks wrong or duplicated. - Open the session in **Sessions** to see the details. - If it is a genuine duplicate (for example from importing the same file twice), you can remove the extra one. - If a client booked the wrong service or time, use **Move to a new date & time**, or cancel and rebook.

There are no available times for a client to book. - Check your **availability** settings (Section 11); the portal only shows open slots you have set. - Confirm the slots are not all already reserved (including by direct booking links you sent).

The gallery or delivery link does not work for the client. - Confirm the link works for you first by opening it yourself. - For photo galleries, confirm the gallery in **CloudSpot** is published and shared, not still private. - Repaste the correct link on the session and confirm delivery again.

Bookings are not showing on your Google or Apple calendar. - Check the calendar sync settings (Section 15) and that the connection is still active. - New bookings should appear once connected; if the connection dropped, reconnect it.

A session is for a child under 18. - The booking flow handles this: the client checks a box saying the session is for a minor and that they are the parent or guardian signing on the child's behalf, and they sign the minor version of the release. You do not need to do anything special; just be aware that is how minors are handled.

A client wants a refund. - Refunds are issued through **Square**, not the portal. Handle the refund in Square, then note it on the session so your records match.

Something else looks broken or you are unsure. - If it touches a client's money or data and you are not certain, it is worth checking with Dennis (or whoever maintains the portal) rather than guessing. - The separate maintenance guide covers the deeper technical side, if it is that kind of problem.

This guide describes the portal as it works today. If a screen looks different or a step has changed, trust the screen, and feel free to note the change here so the guide stays accurate.